

CEDRIC P.-E. MANOUAN

APPLIED AI RESEARCH ENGINEER

Location : Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

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EDUCATION

Master of Science | *Information Technology - Applied Machine Learning* August 2021 – May 2023
Carnegie Mellon University - College of Engineering, CMU-Africa Kigali, Rwanda

Master of Science (Semester 7) | *Information Systems and Software engineering* October 2019 – March 2020
Ecole Supérieure Africaine des TIC (ESATIC) Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

Bachelor of Science | *Systems, Computer Networks and Telecommunications* October 2016 – September 2019
Ecole Supérieure Africaine des TIC (ESATIC) Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

WORK EXPERIENCE

International Finance Corporation (IFC), World Bank Group April 2024 – June 2026
Project Analyst and Coordinator - AI Associate Specialist (Short Term Consultant) Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

- Provided analytical Support for a Note on Private Capital Mobilization in Artificial Intelligence
- Reviewed Digital Compacts in West Africa (for Togo & Côte d'Ivoire)
- Provided analytical guidance on data centers and digital infrastructure investment (relevant, efficient and affordable devices)
- Piloted the organisation of a regional brown bag lunch (BBL) on AI developments in West & Central Africa
- Supported the preparation of the AI-related materials that shaped IFC's contribution to the GITEX Africa 2026 panel on AI, Science & Global Collaboration presented by our Division Director
- Co-authored 3 AI landscape reports on startups and AI covering Cameroon, Côte d'Ivoire and Senegal
- Contributed key inputs on AI and digital skills to the preparation of the World Bank's Digital Acceleration Program in Côte d'Ivoire (PADCI)
- Coordinated the participation of the CAE team to the Global AI Summit on Africa (April 2025)
- Cross-cutting Technical and Operational Support: liaised with WBG teams, other DFIs and private sector

Polytechnic University of Bingerville (UPB) May 2025 – Present
Part Time Instructor (Undergraduate Courses) Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

Techclick, UNDP & Rwanda Ministry of ICT and Innovation (MINICT) October 2023 – March 2024
Consultant - AI Readiness Assessment (AIRA) Kigali, Rwanda

- Supported the UNDP team with the qualitative assessment of the AI landscape
- Conducted interviews with key informants from government institutions;
- Contributed to clarifying the roadmap for the implementation of the National AI Policy
- Suggested a prioritization matrix for the National AI Policy

Carnegie Mellon University Africa July 2024 – June 2025
Consultant (AI Engineer)/Principal Research Associate, Wakanda AI, AFRETEC Network (Remote) Kigali, Rwanda

- Drafted initial paperwork (proposal, budget, work plan);
- Speech processing, Language modeling; Seamless communication; African languages

— May – December 2023
Research Associate, AI & Robotics Lab Kigali, Rwanda

- Implementation of a Semantically-modulated Joint Episodic-Procedural (S-JEP) Working Associative Memory
- Pittsburgh Supercomputing Center (PSC): Computing resources allocation manager
- **S-JEP Final Report:** <https://tinyurl.com/SJEPCMUAFRICA>

— Fall 2022 & Spring 2023
Graduate Research and Teaching Assistant Pittsburgh, PA / Kigali, Rwanda

- 11785 - Introduction to Deep Learning
- 04800-AB Machine Learning for Earth Observation

Ivorian Electricity Company (CIE)

AI Analyst Intern

June 2022 – July 2022

Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

Zindi

Software Engineering/Data science Intern

April 2021 – July 2021

Remote

PSNDEA

Software Developer Intern (Projet de Fin d'Études)

May 2019 – July 2019

Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

- IoT Project of Digital Solutions for the opening up of Rural Areas and e-Agriculture
- Grade: highest honors

SKILLS

Programming (Python/C++) & Software/AI Engineering: Data structures and Algorithms; Deep Learning (PyTorch (model design, training, evaluation and monitoring); Large Language Models; Agentic and local AI); API development (FastAPI/NodeJS), Amazon Web Services (AWS/EC2); CI/CD; Docker.

High-performance computing (HPC): Distributed job scheduling on compute (GPU) clusters, resource management, and batch script development using SLURM.

Consulting: Information Technology (IT), AI (Governance; Readiness Assessment; Engineering; Project Management).

FEATURED PROJECTS

DipR AI - Building the Intelligence Layer for African AI | *Stealth AI Startup*

Founder & CEO

Take The Train - Africa at the Crossroad of Modern AI | *Independent Research*

March 2026

Paper link: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.21795>

- Led research on Africa's AI landscape, identifying barriers in infrastructure, accessibility, governance, and human capital; proposed a framework for sustainable AI adoption across Sub-Saharan Africa.
- Invited Talk to the *vibe coding* Hackathon (VIBEATHON 2026) hosted in Abidjan (July 2026).

Wakanda AI - Advanced Speech Technologies for African Languages (2024-2027) | *CMU-Africa*

Consultant (AI Engineer), Principal Research Associate

\$250,000 Research grant to Advance the Inclusive Digital Transformation of Africa, funded by the Mastercard Foundation through the AFRETEC Network.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

VIBEATHON CI 2026

July 2026

Jury Member, Keynote Speaker

Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

Carnegie Mellon University, Language Technologies Institute (LTI)

Fall 2026

Volunteer Teaching Assistant (11785 - Introduction to Deep Learning)

Remote

Advanced Computing and Data Resource Program (ACCESS)

2023 - 2025

Member, Researcher Advisory Committee

Remote, USA

REFERENCES

Prof. Bhiksha Raj	Professor, Language Technologies Institute, CMU	bhiksha@cs.cmu.edu
Prof. David Vernon	Emeritus Research Professor, CMU-Africa	david@vernon.eu
Dr. Moise Busogi	Assitant Teaching Professor, CMU-Africa	mbusogi@andrew.cmu.edu
Ms. Jeanne Yamfashije	Lead Project Manager, Techclick, Smart Africa	jeanne@techclick.rw
Ms. Meritxell Martinez	Senior Operations Officer, IFC	mmartinez1@ifc.org
Mr. Paul Nguyen	Digital Specialist, The World Bank	pnguyen19@worldbank.org